UNIVERSITY OF CAPE COAST
DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES
CMS 107: COMMUNICATIVE SKILLS

Study the passage below carefully and write a SUMMARY of it in not more than 100 words. Provide your SUMMARY with a heading.

The day the harvest was due to begin, everything was ready as usual. The sun had risen, but it suddenly disappeared and the sky grew quite dark. We heard a distant rumble, quite unlike the sound of thunder: besides, it was the dry season, and it would have been quite astonishing from a storm to break out suddenly like this. But the sky had rapidly lowered; the rumble had grown till it resembled the sound of an enormous swarm of bees, a gigantic buzzing. As the meaning suddenly became apparent, panic-stricken cries of distress were heard: "Locusts".

Everyone immediately dropped their baskets and seized empty receptacle, iron hoes, anything they could lay their frantic hands on to make noise with; they began to make a deafening din as they ran towards the fields, beating the receptacles as hard as they could. I wanted to do what I could to help, to show myself able to rise to the occasion. I took my bow and three quivers full of arrows and made my way towards our field.

The sky, which hung above our heads, seemed suddenly to crash to the ground; the sun reappeared and the sultriness vanished. My father clasped me affectionately to him, saying in a voice touched with emotion, "My poor boy! I admire your courage but neither a bow nor poisoned arrows are any good against locusts. Stamp your feet, make a noise with a stick; that's the only thing you can do."

There were locusts everywhere; the grain field was covered with them, crawling, hopping, and jumping from ear to ear. They made a noise like the snapping of hundreds of thousands of fingers; like the cracking of hundreds and hundred thousands of nuts; like the nervous clicking of scissors; like people strenuously tearing calico: it was a snapping and a rapping, a roaring, a creaking and squeaking, a rattling and rumbling. The locusts went rampaging on, harvesting in their fashion. The ears of grain vanished in their path, the stalks fell, cut into tiny pieces.

We shouted and yelled, crushing the filthy creatures, which seemed to multiply in spite of our furious efforts. All in vain! In next to no time the field was completely devastated and what was left of the swarm took to the wings again as if obeying rallying cry, some imperative call to arms, bearing disaster with them in their flight.